

East Lansing Late-night Dining Finder

'Night Owl Dining'

Description: East Lansing Late-night Dining Finder App solves a genuine, localized problem every student at MSU faces, finding food when the major campus dining halls close, or keeping track of variable late-night restaurant hours along Grand River Avenue. MSU students studying late at the library, working on engineering projects in computer labs, or returning from late-night activities lack a centralized, real-time tool to find open food options. Popular platforms like Google Maps or Yelp often fail to capture real-time holiday hours, campus dining hall modifications (Eat at State hours), delivery-only constraints, or exclusive student discounts active past 10:00 PM. The app implements features that make finding late-night food options easier, quicker and more accessible.

Core App Features:

- The filtering function: The app takes multiple inputs, like the time, location, taste description to evaluate proximity and availability of a certain number of restaurants or dining locations that are found to be the most preferable. (Could use a map interface)
- Campus vs Off-Campus Categorization: The app includes retail options from MSU Union, Sparty's, and Eat at State retail dining alongside Grand River.
- Safety Integration: A button that links directly to MSUPD Safe Ride or shows well-lit walking paths to the restaurant.

Emphasizing the constraints:

- Economic Constraint: How will the app remain free for students? (e.g., Sponsored local ads from Grand River restaurants offering midnight coupons).
- Technical/Feasibility Constraint: Keeping restaurant operating hours updated without manual entry. (Proposed solution: Integrating a crowdsourcing feature where users can click "Still Open" or "Closed" to update the app live).
- Sustainability/Social Impact: Helping local businesses reduce food waste by allowing them to blast "late-night flash sales" through your app to hungry college students.

Restaurant Name	General Late-Night Vibe	Why Students Need It
Crunchy's	Legendary burgers and tots	Open late; iconic local student hub.
HopCat	Cosmik fries and burgers	Kitchen serves late on weekends downtown.
Conrad's Grill	Late-night wraps/tater tots	The quintessential "open until 2 or 3 AM" East Lansing staple.
Bell's Greek Pizza	Pizza, grinders, and gyros	Longtime Grand River favorite known for late delivery.
Sparty's (Select)	Campus convenience	Quick snacks using Combo-X-Change when open late.